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Security News This Week: The FBI Wants ‘Near Real-Time’ Access to US License Plate Readers

Plus: Google publishes a live exploit for an unpatched flaw, the feds arrest two men accused of creating thousands of nonconsensual deepfake nudes, and more.



SAVE THIS STORY

A WIRED investigation this week found that a former Phoenix police officer who owns a company that offers firearms training to Immigration and Customs enforcement was involved in six shootings, four of which were deadly. Meanwhile, a New York police officer’s lawyer has been banned from Madison Square Garden amid a lawsuit the cop filed over injuries sustained during a boxing match at an MSG venue.

tactics to keep people from opting out.

The Federal Trade Commission this week announced a settlement with three marketing firms—not because they sold “Active Listening” technology for serving targeted advertising, but because the technology allegedly did not work.

A bipartisan pair of US lawmakers this week took an initial stab at cracking down on automatic license plate readers, or ALPRs. Their legislation would have effectively prevented state and local governments from using the surveillance tech for police tracking.

GitHub, the popular Microsoft-owned code repository, suffered a data breach this week. The attack is part of a never-before-seen string of similar breaches carried out by the cybercrime group TeamPCP.

Finally, as the Trump administration and US tech companies have grown increasingly intertwined, European nations are looking for US-free alternatives, with France leading the charge.

And that’s not all. Each week, we round up the security and privacy news we didn’t cover in depth ourselves. Click the headlines to read the full stories. And stay safe out there.

The FBI Wants ‘Near Real-Time’ Access to License Plate Readers Across the US

While US lawmakers stealthily proposed to prohibit the use of automated license plate readers across the country this week, it has also been revealed that the

passing vehicle, adding their license plate, location, time and data, into searchable databases that are often accessed by local law enforcement agencies and some federal agencies.

“The FBI has a crucial need for accessible LPRs to provide a diverse and reliable range of collections across the United States,” a statement of work says. “This data should be available across major highways and in an array of locations for maximum usefulness to law enforcement.” Further documents said the access to data must be provided in “near real time.”

Google Publishes Live Exploit Code for Unpatched Chromium Flaw

Google this week made public a working proof-of-concept for an unfixed vulnerability in Chromium, the open source codebase underpinning Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Brave, Opera, Vivaldi, and Arc, reported Ars Technica. The flaw was originally reported to the company 42 months ago by independent researcher Lyra Rebane, who initially assumed Wednesday's posting to the project's bug tracker meant a patch had finally shipped. It hadn't. Google pulled the disclosure after the error became apparent, but the exploit code is already mirrored on archival sites.

The bug abuses the Browser Fetch API, a feature meant to handle large background downloads, allowing any website a target visits to spin up a persistent service worker on the device. The resulting connection can be used to monitor browsing activity, route traffic through the victim's machine, or pull the device into a proxied DDoS network—connections that survive browser restarts and, in

Google's own engineers tagged the bug as serious in the original disclosure thread, assigning it a multiple high-severity tiers in the company's internal ranking system. Firefox and Safari are unaffected, as neither implements the relevant feature. Google said it is working on a fix. Users seeing unprompted download windows should treat them as suspect.

Feds Arrest Men Allegedly Behind Deepfake Sexual Abuse Watched Millions of Times

Ever so slowly, a crackdown on people creating deepfake sexual abuse images may be starting. In recent months, the UK and the EU have announced plans to ban so-called nudifying websites that create fake nude images of women and girls using artificial intelligence. With the increasing enforcement of the Take It Down Act since May 19, similar pressure is being applied in the US.

This week, the Federal Trade Commission sent a letter to 12 companies offering nudifying services, warning them they may be in violation of the Act saying they should have a process “through which victims can request the removal of nonconsensual intimate images.” While not limiting the services’ content, the move increases scrutiny on the harmful sites.

The Department of Justice also arrested two men for allegedly sharing “thousands” of AI-created photos and videos showing real women nude or involved in sex acts. The men, Cornelius Shannon, 51, and Arturo Hernandez, 20, are alleged to have uploaded the AI creations to pornography websites and video sharing platforms. The images and videos, which prosecutors say were viewed millions of times, included celebrities and politicians, but also women known to

A former managing assistant US attorney in Fort Pierce has been charged with stealing a copy of the sealed report Jack Smith produced on his investigation into Donald Trump's handling of classified documents after Trump's first term, according to the Washington Post.

Carmen Mercedes Lineberger, 62, allegedly forwarded the document to a personal email account in January 2025, relabeling the attachment “Bundt_Cake_Recipe.pdf”—a step prosecutors describe as an effort to dodge detection. She pleaded not guilty Wednesday to four felony charges, including theft of government property. Her lawyer has not responded to requests for comment, and the indictment is silent on what she intended to do with the file.

Smith finished the summary in the closing days of the Biden administration. Unlike the companion volume covering his January 6 investigation, this one was never released publicly. Judge Aileen M. Cannon—who had earlier tossed the 40-count classified-documents indictment against Trump on the grounds that Smith's appointment was unlawful—initially sealed the report temporarily to protect those named but uncharged, then made the seal permanent after Trump's legal team and a Justice Department staffed by several of his former defense attorneys pressed for it.

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OpenAI Rolls Out ‘Advanced’ Security Mode for At-Risk Accounts

OpenAI is rolling out Advanced Account Security for people concerned that their ChatGPT or Codex accounts could be potential targets of phishing attacks.

LILY HAY NEWMAN

A Bipartisan Amendment Would End Police License Plate Tracking Nationwide

One line tucked into a federal highway bill would strip funds from cities and states unless they kill their automated plate tracking programs—effectively banning the tech for all but toll collection.

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Cybercriminal Twins Caught After They Forgot to Turn Off Microsoft Teams Recording

Plus: Instructure's Canvas ransomware debacle comes to a close, an alleged dark net market kingpin gets arrested, OpenAI workers fall victim to a supply chain attack, and more.

ANDREW COUTS

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You Can Get Some of Your Nudes Removed From the Internet Under a New Law

Starting May 19, tech platforms in the US will have to comply with the Take It Down Act. Here's how more than a dozen major platforms are handling takedown demands for your nonconsensual nudes.

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‘Creepy’ Listening Tool for Targeted Ads Didn’t Actually Work, FTC Says

Three firms will pay nearly \$1 million for selling “Active Listening” technology that they claimed tapped people’s phones for advertising. The FTC alleges the “tech” was just pricey email lists.

MADDY VARNER

The Race Is on to Keep AI Agents From Running Wild With Your Credit Cards

AI agents may soon be buying your stuff for you. The FIDO Alliance has teamed up with Google and Mastercard to try to ensure that shopping in the near future isn't a complete disaster.

LILY HAY NEWMAN

Trump's Inner Circle Is Already Scrambling Over the 2028 Presidential Ticket

Republicans still have the midterms to get through, but administration officials have already set their sights on the next election.

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An Engineer's Post Protesting Laptop Surveillance Is Going Viral Inside Meta

Meta employees in the US and UK are organizing against corporate software that tracks workers' keystrokes and mouse activity.

PARESH DAVE

An ICE Firearms Trainer Was Involved in At Least 4 Deadly Shootings

David Norman, a former Phoenix police officer who's described himself as "a fucking savage," now runs a company that provided training to Homeland Security's Special Response Teams.

ALI WINSTON

